territory of the People's Republic of China'. This formulation was repeated in the 2003, 2005, and 2006 statements signed by the two sides.

Towards conflict

However, in 2008, Indian policy abruptly shifted. The joint document issued on 14 January 2008 during Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's visit to Beijing and the joint communiqué issued at the end of Premier Wen Jiabao's visit to New Delhi in 2010 omitted any reference to Tibet, even as it repeated India's adherence to the one-China policy.[111] The 2010 communique went further, dropping reference to both Tibet and the one-China policy while endorsing the 'basic principles and consensus' on bilateral relations set out in 2003, 2005, 2006, and 2008.[112] What caused the change? In all probability, India's reluctance to endorse its earlier statements on Tibet was related to its unhappiness over a series of Chinese actions on Arunachal Pradesh.[113]

Beginning in 2006, India concluded that China had hardened its position on Arunachal Pradesh. In November 2006, the Chinese ambassador in India stated, 'In our position [sic], the whole of the state of Arunachal Pradesh is Chinese territory. And Tawang is only one of the places in it. We are claiming all of that. That is our position'.[114] Then, in June 2007, Chinese Foreign Minister Yang Jiechi told Indian External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee that the 'mere presence of populated areas in Arunachal Pradesh would not affect Chinese claims on the boundary' – this seemed to repudiate Article VI of the 2005 agreement on the nature of a final settlement.[115] Also in June 2007, an Indian official from Arunachal Pradesh was denied a Chinese visa. These moves were followed in November 2008 by Chinese objections to Pranab Mukherjee's visit to Tawang and in October 2009 to Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's visit to the state.

The reasons for China's tougher position on Arunachal Pradesh from 2006 onward are still something of a mystery. According to Prem Shankar Jha, the veteran journalist, Beijing's new stance was related to